Spring option 1

What we are eating

- **Lunch, Mon to Wed:** Polish potato salad
- **Lunch, Thu and Fri (and Wednesday's dinner):** Gochujang tofu bowls (mild)
- **Dinner, Mon and Tue:** Vegetarian bibimbap
- **Dinner, Thu and Fri:** Zapiekanka
- **Breakfast:** Apple cinnamon overnight oats **Snack:** Energy balls
- **For him only:** Plain baked chicken breast, diced: 10 portions of 100 g (about 1.3 kg raw), added to his lunches, Wednesday's dinner and the kopytka.
- **Weekend:** Soba noodle salad for lunch and Kopytka (potato dumplings) for dinner, both days; eggs on toast for breakfast.

The week at a glance

DAYS	BREAKFAST	LUNCH (PACKED)	SNACK	DINNER	DAY TOTAL
Mon, Tue	**Apple cinnamon overnight oats** **HIM** 1 jar + banana + milk 250 mL 534 kcal, 27 g **HER** 1 jar + banana 404 kcal, 18 g	**Polish potato salad** **HIM** 4 parts + 100 g diced chicken 652 kcal, 48 g **HER** 3 parts + cottage cheese 125 g 465 kcal, 27 g	**Energy balls** **HIM** 2 balls + Greek yogurt 175 g 392 kcal, 25 g **HER** 1.5 balls + Greek yogurt 175 g 326 kcal, 23 g	**Vegetarian bibimbap** **HIM** 4 parts 592 kcal, 29 g **HER** 3 parts 444 kcal, 21 g	**HIM** **2170 kcal**, 129 g **HER** **1640 kcal**, 89 g
Wed	**Apple cinnamon overnight oats** **HIM** 1 jar + banana + milk 250 mL 534 kcal, 27 g **HER** 1 jar + banana 404 kcal, 18 g	**Polish potato salad** **HIM** 4 parts + 100 g diced chicken 652 kcal, 48 g **HER** 3 parts + cottage cheese 125 g 465 kcal, 27 g	**Energy balls** **HIM** 2 balls + Greek yogurt 175 g 392 kcal, 25 g **HER** 1.5 balls + Greek yogurt 175 g 326 kcal, 23 g	**Gochujang tofu bowls (mild)** **HIM** 4 parts + 100 g diced chicken 706 kcal, 61 g **HER** 3 parts + apple 500 kcal, 23 g	**HIM** **2283 kcal**, 161 g **HER** **1696 kcal**, 91 g
Thu, Fri	**Apple cinnamon overnight oats** **HIM** 1 jar + banana + milk 250 mL 534 kcal, 27 g **HER** 1 jar + banana 404 kcal, 18 g	**Gochujang tofu bowls (mild)** **HIM** 4 parts + 100 g diced chicken 706 kcal, 61 g **HER** 3 parts + apple 500 kcal, 23 g	**Energy balls** **HIM** 2 balls + Greek yogurt 175 g 392 kcal, 25 g **HER** 1.5 balls + Greek yogurt 175 g 326 kcal, 23 g	**Zapiekanka** **HIM** 4 parts + Greek yogurt 175 g 621 kcal, 38 g **HER** 3 parts + Greek yogurt 175 g 498 kcal, 33 g	**HIM** **2252 kcal**, 151 g **HER** **1729 kcal**, 97 g
Sat	**Eggs on toast** **HIM** 2 eggs, 2 slices sourdough, 1 tsp butter, Greek yogurt 175 g 561 kcal, 37 g **HER** 2 eggs, 1 slice sourdough, 1 tsp butter, apple 406 kcal, 16 g	**Soba noodle salad** **HIM** 4 parts + 100 g diced chicken 518 kcal, 41 g **HER** 3 parts + 1 boiled egg + edamame 100 g 463 kcal, 25 g	**Energy balls** **HIM** 2 balls + Greek yogurt 175 g 392 kcal, 25 g **HER** 1.5 balls + Greek yogurt 175 g 326 kcal, 23 g	**Kopytka (potato dumplings)** **HIM** 4 parts + 100 g diced chicken 629 kcal, 44 g **HER** 3 parts + cottage cheese 125 g 448 kcal, 24 g	**HIM** **2100 kcal**, 147 g **HER** **1644 kcal**, 88 g
Sun	**Eggs on toast** **HIM** 2 eggs, 2 slices sourdough, 1 tsp butter, Greek yogurt 175 g 561 kcal, 37 g **HER** 2 eggs, 1 slice sourdough, 1 tsp butter, apple 406 kcal, 16 g	**Soba noodle salad** **HIM** 4 parts + 100 g diced chicken 518 kcal, 41 g **HER** 3 parts + 1 boiled egg + edamame 100 g 463 kcal, 25 g	**Energy balls** **HIM** 2 balls + Greek yogurt 175 g 392 kcal, 25 g **HER** 1.5 balls + Greek yogurt 175 g 326 kcal, 23 g	**Kopytka (potato dumplings)** **HIM** 4 parts + 100 g diced chicken 629 kcal, 44 g **HER** 3 parts + cottage cheese 125 g 448 kcal, 24 g	**HIM** **2100 kcal**, 147 g **HER** **1644 kcal**, 88 g

"4 parts" and "3 parts" are the his and hers shares of a cooked dish. Numbers are kcal and grams of protein.

The rhythm

Sunday, about 2 hours

1. Start with Polish potato salad (about 30 min). Make the recipe once (6 servings).
2. Then apple cinnamon overnight oats (5 min for all the jars). Make 10 jars.
3. Then energy balls (10 min of work plus 30 min chilling). Make 1 1/2 x the recipe (27 balls).
4. Bake his chicken: about 1.3 kg raw breast with salt, pepper, garlic powder and a little oil, 20 to 25 min at 425 F. Dice it and bag 10 portions of 100 g. Keep 3 in the fridge and freeze the rest, moving them down a day ahead.
5. Box the lunches for Monday to Wednesday. Gochujang tofu bowls (mild) is cooked fresh on Wednesday evening.

The rest of the week

Monday	Cook vegetarian bibimbap (about 50 min). Dinner tonight and tomorrow.
Tuesday	No cooking. Leftovers from Monday.
Wednesday	Cook gochujang tofu bowls (mild) (about 25 min). Eat it for dinner and box Thursday's and Friday's lunches.
Thursday	Cook Zapiekanka (about 30 min). Dinner tonight and tomorrow.
Friday	No cooking.
Saturday	Midday: make soba noodle salad (about 15 min) for today's and tomorrow's lunch. Evening: cook Kopytka (potato dumplings) (about 40 min) for tonight's and tomorrow's dinner. Breakfast both days is eggs on toast.
Sunday	Leftovers from Saturday for lunch and dinner. Afternoon: prep the next option.

Groceries used: $195.38 for both of you for the seven days ($97.69 each). Buying every pack new costs about $350.08 at the till; most of the difference stays in the pantry for later options.

Shopping list: Spring option 1

For both of you, Monday to Sunday. Save-On-Foods prices seen Nov 10, 2026. Check the fridge and pantry first: oats, rice, soy sauce, honey, peanut butter and oil last for several options.

From H Mart, not priced

Gochujang (Korean chili paste); Dried soba noodles, 600 g. Tofu, ginger, green onions and mushrooms are usually cheaper there too.

Pantry check (not on the list below)

Salt, pepper, neutral cooking oil, sugar or brown sugar, flour, cornstarch, vinegar, plus: cinnamon, ginger, cloves, vanilla, sesame seeds, ketchup, red pepper flakes, dried thyme (and about 325 g of the flour), garlic powder.

ITEM	NEED	BUY	PACK PRICE	COST OF AMOUNT USED
Produce				
☐ 3 colour coleslaw mix (Fresh Express)	765 g	2 x 397 g	$3.99	$7.69
☐ Ambrosia apple	11	11 x each, about 207 g	$0.91	$10.01
☐ Banana	10	10 x each	$0.39	$3.90
☐ Bean sprouts	120 g	1 x 227 g	$2.99	$1.58
☐ Carrots	180 g	1 x 5 lb bag	$7.99	$0.63
☐ Cilantro	1 bunch	1 x bunch	$2.49	$2.49
☐ Fresh dill	0.5 bunch	1 x bunch	$3.99	$2.00
☐ Fresh ginger	15 g	loose, by weight	$0.66/100 g	$0.10
☐ Garlic	1 bulb	1 x 3 bulbs	$1.29	$0.43
☐ Green kale	1 bunch	1 x bunch	$4.49	$4.49
☐ Green onions	2 bunch	2 x bunch	$2.49	$4.98
☐ Lime	1.5	2 x each	$0.99	$1.48
☐ White mushrooms, loose	415 g	loose, by weight	$1.32/100 g	$5.48
☐ Yellow onions	230 g	1 x 3 lb bag	$4.99	$0.84
☐ Yellow potatoes	2.5 kg	1 x 10 lb bag	$6.99	$3.85
Meat & deli				
☐ Chicken breast, boneless skinless, warehouse pack	1.3 kg	2 x about 1.25 kg	$20.64	$21.47
Dairy & eggs				
☐ 2% milk (Dairyland)	2.5 L	1 x 4 L	$6.35	$3.97
☐ Cottage cheese 2% (Dairyland)	625 g	1 x 750 g	$8.25	$6.88
☐ Extra firm tofu (Sunrise)	4.54 block	5 x 350 g	$3.99	$18.11
☐ Greek yogurt, plain 2% (Olympic)	4.75 kg	3 x 1.75 kg	$12.29	$33.36
☐ Large white eggs	21	2 x 18	$7.45	$8.69
☐ Medium cheddar block (Western Family)	150 g	1 x 600 g	$8.49	$2.12
☐ Salted butter (Western Family)	62 g	1 x 454 g	$6.69	$0.91
Grains & bakery				
☐ Classic baguette (Bake Shop)	1	1 x 350 g	$3.49	$3.49
☐ Large flake oats (Rogers)	465 g	1 x 1 kg	$5.00	$2.33
☐ Long grain brown rice (Western Family)	195 g	1 x 907 g	$3.99	$0.86
☐ Panko bread crumbs (Western Family)	25 g	1 x 227 g	$3.59	$0.40
☐ Quinoa, bulk bin	115 g	loose, by weight	$1.49/100 g	$1.71
☐ Sourdough bread, sliced (Bake Shop)	6 slice	1 x 567 g, about 12 slices	$3.99	$2.00
☐ Whole grain spaghetti (Catelli), stand-in for soba	400 g	2 x 375 g	$4.29	$4.58
Pantry & cans				
☐ Canned peas (Western Family)	1 can	1 x 398 mL can	$2.59	$2.59
☐ Dijon mustard (Western Family)	5 mL	1 x 325 mL	$3.99	$0.06
☐ Extra virgin olive oil (Western Family)	15 mL	1 x 1 L	$15.99	$0.24
☐ Ground flaxseed (Only Goodness)	91 g	1 x 453 g	$8.99	$1.81
☐ Liquid honey (Western Family)	358 g	1 x 1 kg	$14.79	$5.30
☐ Mayonnaise (Western Family)	45 mL	1 x 890 mL	$6.99	$0.35
☐ Mini semi-sweet chocolate chips (Chipits)	128 g	1 x 270 g	$6.79	$3.21
☐ Natural smooth peanut butter (Western Family)	195 g	1 x 1 kg	$5.99	$1.17
☐ Polskie ogorki dill pickles (Bick's)	4 pickles	1 x 1 L jar, about 12 pickles	$6.99	$2.33
☐ Pure maple syrup (Western Family)	80 mL	1 x 375 mL	$10.99	$2.34
☐ Pure sesame oil (Kosa)	186 mL	2 x 185 mL	$3.99	$4.01
☐ Rice vinegar (Marukan)	135 mL	1 x 355 mL	$5.79	$2.20
☐ Soy sauce, less sodium (Western Family)	225 mL	1 x 450 mL	$3.49	$1.75
Frozen				
☐ Frozen edamame beans (Western Family)	200 g	1 x 500 g	$2.99	$1.20
Allowance for spices, oil, vinegar and the H Mart items below (my estimate, not priced)				**$6.00**
Groceries used for this option, both of you				**$195.38**
At the till if every pack is bought new (the remainder carries into later weeks)				**$350.08**

Cook and split: Spring option 1

In cooking order. The outline is a reminder in my words; follow the linked recipe for amounts of seasoning and exact steps.

Polish potato salad SUNDAY

For Mon, Tue and Wed lunches · Make the recipe once (6 servings) · about 30 min · full recipe: polonist.com/polish-potato-salad (Polonist)

BUY FOR IT 1.5 kg yellow potatoes; 5 large white eggs; 150 g yellow onions; 4 pickles polskie ogorki dill pickles; 1 can canned peas; 1 ambrosia apple; 45 mL mayonnaise; 5 mL dijon mustard; 0.5 bunch fresh dill. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.

OUTLINE 1. Boil the potatoes and the eggs; cool and cube both. 2. Chop the pickles and onion finely; cube the apple. 3. Fold everything with the drained peas, mayonnaise, mustard and plenty of dill.

SPLIT Divide the whole batch into 3 his-and-hers pairs (Mon, Tue and Wed lunches). Fill his 4 parts to her 3: his is about 1.1 of the recipe's servings, hers about 0.86.

SIDES Him: nothing extra. Her: cottage cheese 125 g.

KEEP The page only says to keep it refrigerated. My guidance: 3 days.

REHEAT Eat cold.

ALLERGENS Eggs, mustard

NOTE Polish salatka with apple and peas. Costed with Bick's Polskie ogorki; a Polish deli's kiszone are closer to what the author means.

Apple cinnamon overnight oats SUNDAY

For breakfasts, Mon to Fri · Make 10 jars · about 5 min · full recipe: wellplated.com/apple-cinnamon-overnight-oats (Well Plated)

BUY FOR IT 300 g large flake oats; 5 ambrosia apple; 1.25 L 2% milk; 80 mL pure maple syrup; 1.25 kg greek yogurt, plain 2%; 70 g ground flaxseed. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.

OUTLINE 1. Layer oats, spices, diced apple, milk, maple syrup, yogurt and flax in a jar. 2. Seal and refrigerate overnight; stir before eating.

SPLIT Each weekday: 1 jar for him, 1 jar for her. That uses all 10.

SIDES Him: banana, milk 250 mL. Her: banana.

KEEP Up to 5 days in the fridge in a sealed jar (author).

REHEAT Eat cold from the jar.

ALLERGENS Milk; oats can carry gluten; tree nuts if you use almond milk

NOTE Costed with 2% milk in place of almond milk.

Energy balls SUNDAY

For snacks, Mon to Fri · Make 1 1/2 x the recipe (27 balls) · about 40 min · full recipe: wellplated.com/energy-balls (Well Plated)

BUY FOR IT 165 g large flake oats; 21 g ground flaxseed; 195 g natural smooth peanut butter; 170 g liquid honey; 128 g mini semi-sweet chocolate chips. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.

OUTLINE 1. Stir oats, flax, peanut butter, honey, vanilla and chocolate chips. 2. Chill 30 min, then roll into about 18 balls.

SPLIT Every day including the weekend: 2 balls for him, 1.5 balls for her. 2.5 left over for the weekend or the freezer.

SIDES Him: Greek yogurt 175 g. Her: Greek yogurt 175 g.

KEEP 2 weeks in the fridge, 3 months in the freezer (author).

REHEAT Eat cold.

ALLERGENS Peanuts; chocolate chips usually contain milk and soy; oats can carry gluten

Vegetarian bibimbap MONDAY EVENING

For Mon and Tue dinners · Make the recipe once (4 servings) · about 50 min · full recipe: wellplated.com/vegetarian-bibimbap (Well Plated)

BUY FOR IT	1.15 block extra firm tofu; 45 mL soy sauce, less sodium; 42 g liquid honey; 45 mL pure sesame oil; 1 bunch green kale; 120 g bean sprouts; 0.4 bulb garlic; 15 mL extra virgin olive oil; 0.5 bunch green onions; 115 g white mushrooms, loose; 180 g carrots; 4 large white eggs; 115 g quinoa, bulk bin. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Crisp the tofu. 2. Blanch the kale and bean sprouts separately and dress each with soy and sesame oil. 3. Saute the mushrooms, then the carrot matchsticks. 4. Fry the eggs. Build bowls over quinoa and top with the gochujang sauce.
SPLIT	Divide the whole batch into 2 his-and-hers pairs (Mon and Tue dinners). Fill his 4 parts to her 3: his is about 1.1 of the recipe's servings, hers about 0.86.
SIDES	Him: nothing extra. Her: nothing extra.
KEEP	Vegetables and tofu keep up to 2 days (author), which is why this is a Monday and Tuesday dinner.
REHEAT	Rewarm the vegetables and tofu in a pan; fry the eggs fresh.
ALLERGENS	Soy, wheat (soy sauce), sesame, eggs
H MART	Gochujang (Korean chili paste)
HEAT	The gochujang sauce goes on top, not in the dish: a small dab for her, a full spoon for him.
NOTE	Meatless. Costed with white mushrooms in place of shiitake.

Gochujang tofu bowls (mild) WEDNESDAY EVENING

For Wed dinner, Thu and Fri lunches · Make 3 x the recipe (6 servings) · about 25 min · full recipe: skinnytaste.com/spicy-gochujang-tofu-bowl (Skinnytaste)

BUY FOR IT	3.39 block extra firm tofu; 90 mL soy sauce, less sodium; 135 mL rice vinegar; 51 mL pure sesame oil; 0.6 bulb garlic; 15 g fresh ginger; 21 g liquid honey; 765 g 3 colour coleslaw mix; 0.9 bunch green onions; 195 g long grain brown rice; 1.5 lime. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Press the tofu, then crumble it. 2. Whisk gochujang, soy and vinegar. 3. Fry garlic, ginger and tofu until it starts to brown, add the sauce and cook 5 min more. 4. Dress the slaw mix with vinegar, sesame oil and honey. Serve over rice.
SPLIT	Divide the whole batch into 3 his-and-hers pairs (Wed dinner, Thu and Fri lunches). Fill his 4 parts to her 3: his is about 1.1 of the recipe's servings, hers about 0.86.
SIDES	Him: nothing extra. Her: apple.
KEEP	4 days in the fridge in airtight containers (author).
REHEAT	Warm the tofu and rice 60 to 90 s; keep the slaw cold on the side.
ALLERGENS	Soy, sesame (gochujang can contain wheat)
H MART	Gochujang (Korean chili paste)
HEAT	Spicy as written. For her: use a third of the gochujang (2 tsp per recipe instead of 2 tbsp) and make up the volume with a little extra soy and honey. He stirs more gochujang into his own bowl.
NOTE	Meatless. The recipe makes 2 bowls, so this plan triples it.

Zapiekanka THURSDAY EVENING

For Thu and Fri dinners · Make the recipe once (2 servings) · about 30 min · full recipe: polonist.com/polish-zapiekanka (Polonist)

BUY FOR IT	1 classic baguette; 300 g white mushrooms, loose; 80 g yellow onions; 150 g medium cheddar block. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Halve the baguette lengthwise and scoop out a little crumb. 2. Saute chopped mushrooms and onion 7 to 10 min; season. 3. Fill the bread, cover with grated cheese and bake until golden. 4. Finish with ketchup.
SPLIT	Divide the whole batch into 2 his-and-hers pairs (Thu and Fri dinners). Fill his 4 parts to her 3: his is about 0.57 of the recipe's servings, hers about 0.43.
SIDES	Him: Greek yogurt 175 g. Her: Greek yogurt 175 g.
KEEP	The page gives no storage time. My guidance: cook the mushroom filling once, keep it 2 days, and bake the second night's halves fresh.
REHEAT	Bake 8 to 10 min at 400 F rather than microwaving.
ALLERGENS	Wheat, milk
NOTE	Polish street food. Costed with medium cheddar; the recipe suggests a mild cheese such as gouda.

Soba noodle salad SATURDAY MIDDAY

For Saturday and Sunday lunches · Make 2 x the recipe (4 servings) · about 15 min · full recipe: justonecookbook.com/soba-salad (Just One Cookbook)

BUY FOR IT	400 g whole grain spaghetti, stand-in for soba; 90 mL pure sesame oil; 126 g liquid honey; 90 mL soy sauce, less sodium; 0.6 bunch green onions; 1 bunch cilantro. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Warm the oils with chili flakes for 3 min, then whisk in honey and soy. 2. Boil the soba, rinse well under cold water and drain. 3. Toss noodles with the dressing, scallions, cilantro and sesame seeds.
SPLIT	Divide the whole batch into 2 his-and-hers pairs (Saturday and Sunday lunches). Fill his 4 parts to her 3: his is about 1.1 of the recipe's servings, hers about 0.86.
SIDES	Him: nothing extra. Her: 1 boiled egg, edamame 100 g.
KEEP	Up to 3 days in an airtight container (author).
REHEAT	Eat cold.
ALLERGENS	Soy, wheat (soba and soy sauce), sesame
H MART	Dried soba noodles, 600 g
HEAT	Leave out the optional chili flakes, or use a pinch; he adds chili oil to his.
NOTE	The recipe serves 2, so this plan triples it. Costed with spaghetti as a stand-in because Save-On lists no soba; buy the real thing at H Mart.

Kopytka (potato dumplings) SATURDAY EVENING

For Saturday and Sunday dinners · Make the recipe once (8 servings) · about 40 min · full recipe: polonist.com/polish-kopytka-dumplings (Polonist)

BUY FOR IT	1 kg yellow potatoes; 2 large white eggs; 42 g salted butter; 25 g panko bread crumbs. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Boil the potatoes in their skins, peel, mash or rice them and cool. 2. Knead quickly with flour, eggs and salt. 3. Roll into thumb-thick ropes and cut into small diagonal pieces. 4. Boil in salted water until they float; top with butter-toasted breadcrumbs.
SPLIT	Set 3 servings aside first for the freezer or the weekend. Divide the rest into 2 his-and-hers pairs (Saturday and Sunday dinners). Fill his 4 parts to her 3: his is about 1.4 of the recipe's servings, hers about 1.1.
SIDES	Him: 100 g diced chicken. Her: cottage cheese 125 g.
KEEP	The page gives no storage time; the author says to reheat by frying or in the microwave. My guidance: 3 days in the fridge; freeze the spare dumplings on a tray.
REHEAT	Fry gently in a little butter (author's preference), or microwave 60 to 90 s.
ALLERGENS	Wheat, eggs, milk (butter)
NOTE	You also need about 325 g of flour from the pantry. The recipe makes 8 servings: this plan eats 5 over two nights and freezes 3.